

To-Go Box

- The strength of your leadership flows from the sincerity of your prayers.
- God is pleased when you ask for wisdom to serve others well.
- Solomon’s legacy began not with a throne, but with a conversation with God.

Carry this truth into your week:

Ask God for wisdom first—then trust Him with everything else.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for the example of Solomon’s request. Teach me to value wisdom over wealth and understanding over image. Align my heart with Your priorities so that my prayers please You. Give me an understanding heart to serve well wherever You have placed me. Let my life reflect Your wisdom and bring You honor. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – “Wisdom First” (Fill-in-the-Blank)

Complete the statements based on today’s lesson:

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did *not* ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s legacy teaches us that _____ comes before _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Note Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

Use this space to jot down insights, testimonies, or key points from group discussion:

BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus

Prayer the First Resort

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8; John 17

 **Key Verse:** Luke 18:1 (WEB)

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.”

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. Pressure kept rising. And Jesus did something that still challenges us: **He withdrew to pray.** He didn’t wait until everything broke. He didn’t treat prayer like a backup plan. If we’re asking *WWJD*—here’s a clear answer: **He would pray first, especially when life got louder.**

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first—rest, fun, prayer, or something else?

Main Course – The Mediator and the Model

Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.
May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.

³ Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴ Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us.
Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’

The disciples didn't ask Jesus to teach them crowds, platforms, or popularity—they asked about prayer. They watched His life and realized **prayer was the engine**. Jesus gave them a pattern: start with God's holiness and Kingdom, trust Him for daily needs, walk in forgiveness, and ask for strength in temptation.

Reflection Question

Which part of that pattern do you rely on most—worship, daily needs, forgiveness, or spiritual strength? Which part do you skip?

Bite 2 — Don't Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn't fear God, and didn't respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn't for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

Jesus tells a story about persistence because He knows how the mind and heart works. Delay can make you tired. Silence can make you doubt. But Jesus is clear: **don't give up**.

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8

⁶ The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷ Won't God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸ I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

CST Thought

God keeps His promises—always. Even in seasons of delay or confusion, His Word sustains us.

Jeremiah 29 reminds us to seek God, pray for the welfare of the place we're in, and trust His larger plan for our lives.

Author's Testimony – A Lesson in Trust

One morning, I began my day with prayer:

“Lord, please be in charge of today. Allow me to rely on Your peace. Take control of today.”

Before 8 a.m., everything seemed to go sideways. A tenant's water was shut off, and there were other moving pieces that could have easily sent me into stress mode. But instead of panicking, I felt an unexpected peace.

God quietly reminded me, “Just call the local store.”

I did. They gave me the name of a retired plumber. He came out, fixed the issue, and the cost was exactly the \$40 I had withdrawn the night before—without knowing why I would need it. That's God's foresight and favor.

Reflection Questions

1. What situation did you trust Jesus to handle, and what was the result?

Dessert — Prayer that Unites, John 17:20–21

“Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who believe in me through their word, that they may all be one, even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.”

Even before the cross, Jesus prayed for us. He sought the Father for strength, direction, and surrender. That's the model: **prayer in the beginning, prayer in the middle, prayer at the finish.**

To-Go Box

- This life is not over until your last breath.
- Keep praying. Keep trusting. Keep resting in the One who intercedes for you.
- “Pray without ceasing.” (1 Thessalonians 5:17, WEB)

Carry this truth into every season: Jesus still meets you first in prayer.

 Group Prayer – Following Jesus’ Example

Remember Jesus’ prayer in Gethsemane and His High Priestly prayer in John 17. Pray for unity, peace, and strength.

“Lord, help us to surrender our will to Yours. Teach us to rest in Your promises, and fill us with the same glory and unity You shared with the Father. Make us one in heart and purpose.

In Jesus’ name, amen.”

 Notes Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Prayer, The First Resort/Praise in Midnight Moments

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34; Isaiah 26:3; Phil 4:6–7

 **Key Verse:** Acts 16:25–26 (WEB)

But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened."

Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3

You will keep whoever's mind is steadfast in perfect peace, because he trusts in you.

Although no one was promised the “Easy St” while spreading the Word of God, your trust that you have in him, no matter the situation is the setup for victory. God promises perfect peace to those who fix their minds on Him. His peace is not the absence of trouble, but a deep, enduring confidence in His unchanging nature.

Reflection Question

When has God given you peace when everything around you said panic?

Main Course – Power in the Praises

Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31

²²The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴who, having received such a charge, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks."

Paul and Silas helped set a slave girl free from a spirit that was controlling her.
Instead of getting a “thank you,” they were:

- Stripped
- Beaten
- Thrown into the **inner prison**
- Locked in stocks

Oftentimes we don't hear an immediate 'thank you' for doing what is right. Our response shouldn't be based on what they do in return, but when he has called us to do – period. That's the test, our follow-through produces the testimony.

Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26

²⁵ But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. ²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened."

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

It's amazing what can happen when you keep your mind stayed on Him (see Isaiah 26:3). Their voices turned a prison into a sanctuary, and their pain became a praise report. Sometimes your midnight melody becomes someone else's breakthrough song. **That's what made the jailhouse rock!** Certain songs, like "Holy Forever" by CeCe Winans, strengthen my heart when life feels heavy because they lift my focus off the problem and onto His power.

Reflection Question

What worship song or prayer brings you back to peace when life feels heavy?

Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30

²⁷ The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, 'Don't

harm yourself, for we are all here!’ ²⁹ He called for lights and sprang in, and, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, ‘Sirs, what must I do to be saved?’

CST Thought

“Do thyself no harm”

The guard fell asleep on duty, and it could have cost him his life! He didn’t want to face his boss and try to explain why the prison was empty (with dried drool on his face)! Paul and Silas’s praise didn’t just free them—it freed everyone in earshot.

The first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stayed, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line. Their pain became the door to someone else’s **salvation**.



Word Study

Yadah (Hebrew) –means praise



Reflection Question

Who has been influenced by your praise or perseverance?



Dessert – Joy Unspeakable Joy, Acts 16:31–34

³¹ They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’ ³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house.

³³ He took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house, and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.”

CST Commentary

Praise is contagious, and faith is transferable. Paul and Silas’s obedience led to the warden’s family’s salvation. The first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stayed, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line. Their pain became the door to someone else’s **salvation**.

What began as a night of pain ended in joy—unspeakable joy.

To-Go Box

- When you choose praise over panic, God moves immediately.
- He can still shake foundations, open doors, and loose chains—not just yours, but everyone within reach of your faith.
- No matter what the problem, Jesus will always be the answer.

Carry this truth into every season:

Your midnight praise can become somebody else's morning miracle.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, Thank You for being with us in our midnight moments. Teach us to choose praise over panic and to trust that You are working even when we cannot see it. Let our worship create an atmosphere where others can experience freedom, salvation, and joy. Use our pain as a platform for Your power. In Your name we pray, amen.”

Reflection & Group Discussion

1. When has God used a hard season in your life to encourage someone else?

2. What is one “midnight situation” you need to surrender to God in praise right now?

3. Who comes to mind when you think about someone who needs to “hear” your praise?

 Group Reflection

Sometimes when the Spirit prompts you to shout or praise, it's not just for you.
Someone within earshot might need that breakthrough.
Glory be to God for every chain that falls when we praise.

 Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best



Activity – Mix & Match

Match each name/phrase with the correct description:

Match		Name/Phrase		Description
B	1	Haman	A	Esther's Uncle
A	2	Mordecai	B	Wanted to destroy Jews
D	3	Vashti	C	Death for coming without summons
C	4	Why Fast was called	D	Refused to come when summoned
E	5	How Haman died	E	By hanging at the Gallows

Answer Key:

- 1 → b (Haman – plotter who wanted to destroy the Jews)
- 2 → a (Mordecai – cousin who refused to bow)
- 3 → d (Vashti – former queen removed)
- 4 → c (The Fast – three days before Esther went to the king)
- 5 → e (The Gallows – where Haman was executed)

Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did not ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s story shows that _____ comes before _____.

Answer Key:

1. wisdom and understanding
2. long life, riches/wealth, or the death/lives of his enemies
3. wisdom comes before wealth

Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort

Activity – “Prayer Map” (Gethsemane-style prayer)

This activity is reflective, not right-or-wrong:

- Students write a two-part prayer:
 - “Father, I feel...” (honesty)
 - “Nevertheless, Your will be done in...” (surrender)

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.

Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark



Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (or your final title)

Students:

1. Write one worship song or phrase that helps them focus on God.
2. Complete: “When I feel _____, this reminds me that God is _____.”

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.

CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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Above all, I give glory to God for every person, prayer, tool, and resource that has helped turn Soul Food from a vision into a living, teaching ministry on the page.

Why Soul Food?



Dr. Dee Brown,
Soul Series Founder

Growing up in Boston, my grandmother, Pastor Pearl Doctor, always brought both the food and the Word to the table. You couldn't walk into her home without smelling something cooking and hearing something spiritual on the radio. Whether you came in upset, excited, nervous, or afraid, she would bring you back to center—with the Word of God in one hand and a plate of food in the other.

She didn't wait until Sunday to offer support. She lived what I now call ***"Truth Served Daily"***—sharing God's Word like heavenly bread alongside whatever she had on the stove. I watched family and friends find peace in that kind of soul food, the kind that nourishes the inner person and prepares us for more than the moment we're in.

This **Soul Food Break*Fast Instructor Edition** was born from that legacy. Designed for teachers, facilitators, and ministry leaders in Bible study circles, cell groups, and Sunday school settings, each lesson offers bite-sized, life-giving "courses" to help your class lay a strong foundation in Christ, deepen fellowship, and share what God is doing in them with others.

The Instructor Edition adds extra tools to support you as you lead: helpful historical notes, dual Scripture references, guidance for activity answers and review material, and tips for navigating "check points" or conversation starters so discussion doesn't stall but moves into the depth and height of biblical truth. It's built to help you direct wholesome, engaging lessons that can be completed in about 75–90 minutes.

Based on the class demographic you're serving, you can pair this Instructor Edition with the matching Soul Food Break*Fast workbook. With the purchase of this paperback, you also receive one free eBook, giving you a comprehensive view of the study as you prepare.

My hope is that these pages bring comfort, clarity, and courage—and inspire you to pass that soul food along.

Be Blessed!



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